



VA.gov → Edge Delivery Services

Migration Assessment & Planning Report

Comprehensive analysis of scope, accessibility requirements,
wave-based migration strategy, team structure, and ROI

Assessment Date: February 26, 2026

Based on live scan of VA.gov site structure, sitemaps, and content patterns

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1. Site Scope & Scale

Based on a live scan of VA.gov sitemaps, page structures, and content patterns:

Category	Estimate
Sitemap URLs (indexed)	~2,150+ across 2 sub-sitemaps
Benefit hub pages	~12 top-level hubs (Health Care, Disability, Education, Pension, Housing, Life Insurance, Burials, Records, Careers, Service Members, Family, VA Dept Info)
Content detail pages	~200-300 (eligibility, how-to, FAQ pages under each hub)
Resource/support articles	~75+ (tagged by topic, dynamic loading)
Facility pages (VAMC systems)	~170+ VA Medical Center systems, each with ~20-30 sub-pages = ~3,500-5,000 facility pages
Event pages	~950+ (dynamically generated, facility-specific)
Forms/applications (React apps)	~30-40 multi-step form wizards (10-10EZ, 526EZ, etc.)
Tools/applications	~10-15 (Find a Location, GI Bill Comparison Tool, Facility Locator, Claim Status Tracker)
Total estimated unique pages	~6,000-8,000+

What is NOT Migratable to EDS (Out of Scope)

- **Multi-step form wizards** - health care applications, disability claims, education benefits
- **Facility Locator** - map-based interactive application
- **GI Bill Comparison Tool** - data-driven application
- **Claim/Appeal Status Tracker** - authenticated, API-driven
- **My HealtheVet portal** - separate authenticated application
- **My VA dashboard** - personalized, authenticated

Estimated non-migratable application pages: ~40-50 distinct apps.

2. Page Template Taxonomy

Template	Count	Complexity	EDS Fit
Homepage	1	High	Good - hero, cards, search, news blocks
Benefit Hub	12	Medium	Excellent - structured content, link lists
Content Detail	~250	Low-Medium	Excellent - text-heavy, sidebar nav
Resource Article	~75	Low	Excellent - simple content + feedback widget
Facility System	~170 systems	Medium-High	Good - location cards, services, stories
Facility Sub-page	~3,500+	Low-Medium	Good - templated content
Event Page	~950	Low	Excellent - structured metadata, simple layout

Block Inventory Needed (~20-25 blocks, ~40-50 variants)

Block	Usage
Hero	Homepage, with search variant
Cards	Benefit categories, 3-column with icons
Link List / Hub Navigation	Benefit hubs, sidebar navigation
Accordion / FAQ	Eligibility pages, expandable sections
Location Card	Facility address, phone, hours
News / Story Teaser	Featured stories with images
CTA Banner	Crisis Line, account creation prompts
Contact Block	Phone numbers, TTY, messaging links
Breadcrumb	Multi-level hierarchy
Feedback Widget	Page rating component
Email Signup	Newsletter subscription
Table	Rate tables, comparison data
Alert / Banner	Government site banner, service alerts
Search	Site search with category filters
Related Benefits	Cross-linking cards at page bottom
Mega Menu Navigation	Complex multi-column dropdown

3. Accessibility Assessment

Highest-risk dimension. VA.gov is a federal government site subject to the strictest accessibility mandates in the United States.

Regulatory Requirements

Standard	Requirement	Impact
Section 508	Federal law - mandatory compliance	Every page must pass
WCAG 2.2 Level AA	VA's stated target	All blocks, all states
21st Century IDEA Act	Digital modernization mandate	Accessibility + usability
ADA Title II	Applies to government digital services	Legal liability

Current VA.gov Accessibility Features Observed

- Skip-to-content links on every page
- ARIA labels and roles throughout navigation
- Veterans Crisis Line accessible via keyboard
- Focus management on dynamic content
- TTY: 711 support referenced site-wide
- Language assistance in Spanish, Tagalog, and other languages
- 508 compliance page with reporting mechanism
- Alt text on images; semantic HTML structure

Migration Accessibility Risks

Risk	Severity	Detail
Mega menu keyboard navigation	Critical	Must maintain tab order, arrow key navigation, escape-to-close
Form widget accessibility	Critical	All ARIA states, error announcements, and focus management must transfer
Dynamic content loading	High	EDS approach must announce content to screen readers
Color contrast in design tokens	High	VA palette must maintain 4.5:1 ratios in all EDS CSS
Mobile responsiveness	High	Must maintain touch targets $\geq 44 \times 44$ px
PDF/document accessibility	Medium	Linked VA forms must remain accessible
Language switching	Medium	Spanish/Tagalog content discoverable by assistive tech
Focus management after navigation	High	SPA-like interactions need focus reset on page transitions

Required Accessibility QA Per Page/Block

- Automated testing (axe-core, Lighthouse)
- Manual screen reader testing (JAWS, NVDA, VoiceOver)
- Keyboard-only navigation testing
- High contrast mode testing
- 200% zoom testing
- Mobile assistive technology testing

4. Wave-Based Migration Plan

Wave 0: Foundation & Design System

Work Item	Size
EDS project scaffolding (boilerplate, aem.json, fstab.yaml)	S
Design token extraction (colors, typography, spacing from VADS)	L
Global styles.css with VA custom properties	M
Header/footer/navigation blocks (mega menu)	XL
Core blocks: Hero, Cards, CTA Banner, Alert, Breadcrumb	L
Accessibility testing framework setup	M
Content authoring guidelines documentation	M
CI/CD pipeline for preview → live promotion	M

Complexity: High - VADS is a React-based component library. Extracting into EDS CSS custom properties and vanilla JS blocks is non-trivial.

Wave 1: Benefit Hub Pages (Pilot)

Work Item	Pages	Size
Hub page template (link lists, section nav, contact block)	12	M
Hub-specific blocks (sidebar nav, related benefits)	-	M
Content migration (12 hub pages)	12	M
Accessibility audit of hub template	-	L
Stakeholder review and sign-off	-	M

Wave 2: Content Detail Pages

Work Item	Pages	Size
Content detail template (sidebar nav, accordion, tables)	~250	L
Accordion/FAQ block	-	M
Table block (rate tables, comparison data)	-	M
Feedback widget block	-	S
Bulk content migration tooling	-	L
Accessibility testing (sampling + automated)	-	L

Wave 3: Resource & Support Articles

Work Item	Pages	Size
Resource article template	~75	M
Topic-based browse/filter	-	M
Content migration	~75	M
Cross-linking and metadata	-	S

Wave 4: Facility Pages (Largest Wave)

Work Item	Pages	Size
Facility system template	~170	L
Facility sub-page templates	~3,500	XL
Location card block with structured data	-	M
Event page template	~950	M
Bulk migration scripting	-	XL
Per-facility content QA	-	XL
Accessibility testing (sampling strategy)	-	L

Key challenge: Scale. Highly templated pages make bulk migration scripting essential.

Wave 5: Homepage & Cross-Cutting Features

Work Item	Pages	Size
Homepage migration (hero, search, news, benefit cards)	1	XL
Site search integration	-	L
Email signup block	-	S
News/blog integration (news.va.gov)	-	M
404 and error pages	-	S
Full site regression testing	-	XL

Wave 6: Application Integration

Work Item	Size
Strategy per application (embed vs. rebuild vs. link)	L
Facility Locator integration/embed	XL
Form application embed strategy	XL
Authentication flow integration	XL
API gateway and backend service connections	XL

Highest technical risk wave - may be an integration strategy rather than full migration.

5. Team Structure

Core Migration Team (15-19 people)

Role	Count	Responsibility
Technical Lead / Architect	1	EDS architecture, block design, integration strategy
EDS Developers	3-4	Block development (JS/CSS), template creation
Content Strategist	1-2	Content mapping, authoring guidelines, IA
Content Migration Engineers	2-3	Bulk migration scripting, content transformation
Accessibility Specialist	2	WCAG/508 testing, remediation, screen reader testing
QA Engineers	2	Visual regression, cross-browser, functional testing
UX Designer	1	Design token mapping, visual fidelity, responsive design
DevOps / Infrastructure	1	CI/CD, preview/live promotion, CDN configuration
Project Manager	1	Sprint planning, stakeholder coordination
Gov Stakeholder Liaison	1	VA approval workflows, compliance, change management

Extended / Part-Time Support

Role	Count	When Needed
VADS expert	1	Wave 0 - design token extraction
React/Application developer	2-3	Wave 6 - application integration
Security reviewer	1	Each wave gate
Performance engineer	1	Waves 4-5 - scale testing
508 Program Office coordinator	1	All waves - compliance sign-off

6. Sprint Structure

Per-Sprint Cadence

Activity	Description
Sprint Planning	Scope page batches, assign blocks, identify risks
Development	Block implementation, content migration, CSS work
Accessibility Check	Automated axe-core scans on all new pages
Visual QA	Screenshot comparison against original
Manual A11y Testing	Screen reader + keyboard testing on sample pages
Stakeholder Demo	Show migrated pages to VA stakeholders
Retrospective	Process improvement, velocity tracking

Definition of Done (Per Page)

- Content migrated accurately (text, links, images, metadata)
- Visual fidelity matches original (responsive at 3 breakpoints)
- Passes axe-core with zero violations
- Passes manual keyboard navigation
- Passes screen reader testing (JAWS or NVDA)
- Color contrast verified at 4.5:1 minimum
- Performance: Lighthouse score $\geq$ 90
- Stakeholder approved
- Preview and live URLs verified

7. ROI & Value Analysis

Current State Pain Points

Issue	Impact
React-based SSR complexity	Heavy build pipeline, slow deployments, developer bottleneck
Page weight	Homepage loads ~2-3MB with JS bundles, analytics, widgets
Content velocity	Authors cannot make content changes without developer involvement
Infrastructure cost	Complex hosting, CDN, and serverless function infrastructure
Performance scores	Moderate Lighthouse scores due to JS-heavy architecture

Edge Delivery Services Value Proposition

Benefit	Detail
Lighthouse 100	EDS consistently achieves perfect Lighthouse scores out of the box
Content velocity	Authors edit in Google Docs/SharePoint, publish in seconds
Reduced JS payload	Vanilla JS blocks vs. React = dramatically smaller page weight
Edge-delivered	Global CDN with sub-second TTFB
Lower infrastructure cost	No build servers, SSR infrastructure, or complex deployment pipeline
Simplified DX	Plain HTML/CSS/JS blocks, no framework lock-in

Quantifiable Value Areas

Performance: Current LCP 2-4s → EDS target <1s. Every 100ms improvement correlates with measurable task completion gains.

Content authoring: Current developer PR cycle → EDS document-based publish in minutes.

Infrastructure: Eliminates React build pipeline, reduces deployment risk, simplifies CDN architecture.

Accessibility: EDS semantic HTML-first approach produces more accessible markup with simpler testing surface.

Risk Factors Affecting ROI

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Application pages cannot migrate	~40-50 React apps remain separate	Embed strategy, gradual rewrite
VA stakeholder approval cycles	Government approval adds overhead	Dedicated liaison, early demos
VADS design system gap	React components won't transfer 1:1	CSS-only recreation
Scale of facility pages	~3,500+ pages	Bulk scripting, templated approach
Accessibility re-certification	Every page needs 508 re-validation	Automated + sampling strategy
Content freeze coordination	Cannot serve from two systems	Wave-based cutover with redirects

8. Migration Sizing Summary

Dimension	Value
Total pages in scope	~5,000-7,000 (content pages, excluding apps)
Pages out of scope (apps)	~40-50 distinct applications
Unique templates	7
Custom blocks needed	~20-25 blocks, ~40-50 variants
Waves	6 (Foundation → Hubs → Detail → Resources → Facilities → Apps)
Core team size	15-19 people
Highest risk	Accessibility compliance, facility page scale, application integration
Highest value	Performance (LCP), content velocity, infrastructure simplification

9. Key Recommendations

1. **Start with a pilot hub** - Migrate one complete benefit hub (e.g., Education) end-to-end before committing to the full site.
2. **Invest heavily in accessibility from day one** - Every block must be built and tested for 508/WCAG 2.2 AA before use. Legal and reputational risk for a federal site is too high.
3. **Build bulk migration tooling early** - With ~3,500+ facility pages following consistent templates, invest in import scripts during Wave 0-1.
4. **Accept a hybrid architecture** - React-based forms and tools will remain as separate applications embedded within EDS pages.
5. **Coordinate with VA Design System (VADS) team** - Close coordination ensures EDS CSS blocks accurately represent the approved design system.
6. **Plan content freeze windows per wave** - Each wave needs a content freeze period during cutover to prevent content drift.

Assessment generated from live scan of VA.gov on February 26, 2026.